

Protect your PC

The lack of awareness is usually the root cause of attacks on the PC to steal data.

<http://bit.ly/s7C8Ue>

Buying gaming laptops

Once considered the 'unwanted' in the gaming world, the laptop isn't going down without a fight

<http://bit.ly/v2cwrR>

Consumer protection

Anchors away at a cost

What to do when the charges they promised would not come, come

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Rohan Dogra, a young professional had just returned from his vacation in Spain. This time, he didn't have much to discuss with friends. With his BlackBerry, sharing pictures and experiences was so easy. Waiting for him back home, though, was a staggering bill from his service provider, who told an astonished Rohan that he'd been charged for data usage. Before leaving for abroad, he was informed by the service provider that no extra roaming charges would be levied for the same. He pointed this to the customer care executives, but all his requests fell on deaf ears. To add salt to his wounds, they barred his outgoing calls initially and ultimately disconnected services due to non payment.

Excess billing is a common problem. Unfortunately, consumers have little resources or options to defend such unreasonable demands. They ultimately end up paying these unreasonable charges being left with no option. If the bill remains unpaid, a disconnection becomes a nuisance, especially for well circulated and old mobile numbers. In such a situation, the consumer should immediately and preferably, through email, register a complaint with the customer care and get a docket number. If unsatisfied with the customer care, the Nodal Officer (a statutory authority to deal with the consumer complaints) can be contacted. The outcome by the nodal officer can be challenged before the respective appellate authority. The addresses, contact numbers and email ids of nodal officers and appellate authorities are

available on the service provider's web site. Consumers generally communicate with their service providers very casually, which ultimately proves to be ineffective. Emailing is a better way to interact with them; it can be helpful for establishing your case if matters go to any adjudicating authority.

Generally, it has been seen that companies settle the disputed amount for a maximum of half of the billed amount. But it does mean that every amount put to challenge can be settled for peanuts. Nevertheless, no company in any case can threaten you or intimidate you through outsider collection agents to pay the bill. If the collection agent abuses or threatens you, inform the police immediately. The companies can recover the outstanding through lawful means only. **d**

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consumer mate

Expert Buying Advice

We can help!

If you're facing a problem with your purchase, write to us at help@consumermate.com

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

LAPTOPS

In three years all laptop parts have been changed; still it continues to give problems

I purchased a laptop from Lenovo 3000 series, model no.7761-1aq, serial no. MA5DL84 in 2008. In the period of three years of buying it, all the parts of the laptop have had to be changed because of a problem occurring a maximum of two times; it still isn't in working condition. I would not advise anyone to purchase any Lenovo product because of third-grade products. I feel like I've been made a fool by this international company. Be aware, I doubt they have any quality standards seeing that their only motive is to make sales.

Contacted By: Ajit Kumar Asati

Answer by Consumermate:

Dear Consumer,
We can understand your pain and disappointment. Thanks for sharing

your inputs and experience about the product which would be beneficial to prospective consumers. You shouldn't feel disappointed and must take legal action against them for providing deficient services. At this stage, write a letter to them in the shape of a legal demand notice detailing all your problems. Please mention all relevant details of earlier job sheets. In case, they don't come up with a solution then you may go ahead with your complaint in the district consumer forum. I hope the company would realise the consumer needs and do the needful to provide proper consumer services so as to maintain its reputation in the market. Please keep proper record of all the relevant documents which would be crucial in establishing your claim

Weak laptop battery after returning from the service centre

I had purchased a mini laptop Aspire d-225 last December. A few months back

it showed some keyboard problem which was solved by the company. Now I guess they have changed my battery as it doesn't last as long as it did before. Now what should I do? It's still in warranty period. Battery condition is bad now after coming from service centre.

Contacted By: Deepak Bhutani

Answer by Consumermate:

Dear Consumer,
You should immediately write to the company about the faults you're coming across after the service. Please match the battery with some corresponding part of the machine; for example, you can match the serial number of the battery with the machine. Even if it isn't changed with someone else's product, you should report the battery problem to the service centre at the earliest. Please check your warranty status for the battery. If it's under warranty then they're duty bound to change it without any cost. **d**